And when it comes to his personal wealth, like other eminent Tata personalities, Ratan has committed it to a trust. He is, however, reluctant to reveal parts of his will stating that it may not be right to divulge its contents before the executor is entitled to know its contents. But he reveals that his personal wealth would be put in a separate trust and would be committed to a different set of social goals. It would also be run separately and at a certain point of time, if it makes pragmatic sense, it could be brought under the umbrella organization of Tata Trusts.

Then it would be managed just as the other thirteen trusts that now constitute Tata Trusts, which were brought under one management after Ratan took over as chairman of the body. Ratan says: '… my worth would be very small or minuscule compared to what they [whose trusts now constitute Tata Trusts] left behind but what I would leave behind would principally be for charity'. But the resources that Ratan has provided through his entrepreneurship for charity is many times that he has earmarked from his personal funds.

In steering Tata Sons and its companies through perhaps the most trying period in the history of the group and growing its turnover more than thirty-six times (in rupee terms) as chairman, Tata Sons, and by increasing the profits of the holding company at a CAGR of over 28 per cent during the more than twenty-one years he was at the helm, Ratan brought more dividends to the Trusts besides increasing the financial resources of Tata companies to give more to social causes. This is perhaps even more significant than what Ratan, in his characteristically understated style, calls the 'minuscule' personal wealth that he has committed to charity. In earning for Tata Sons higher dividends which feed back to the Trusts, he has been instrumental in it being able to commit much more significantly to charity than they had ever before, in the process helping it to remain the largest charitable trust in the nation and the highest contributor to philanthropy in the world.